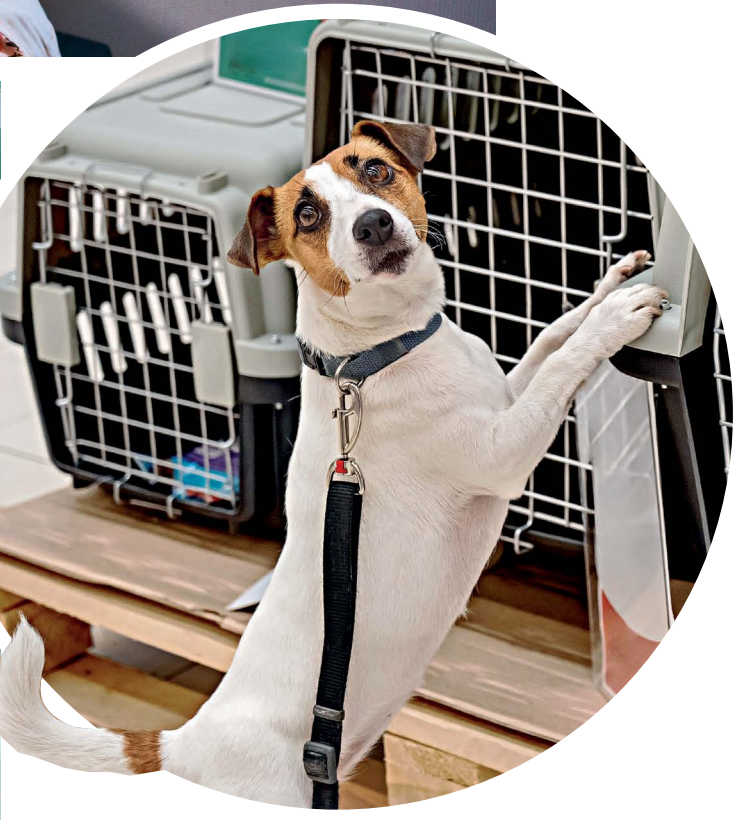


At Air India, cats and dogs must be at least three months old. Up to 10 kg, including the carrier, they may travel in the cabin; heavier animals can travel in the hold



for a pet travelling in the hold.

Around 60% of Akasa's pet passengers have been dogs and the rest cats, while the Bengaluru-Delhi-Bengaluru sector accounts for 13.66% of its pet traffic.

The Amadeus Travel Trends Report 2026 refers to it as the "Pawprint Economy", pointing to forecasts that the global pet industry could be worth $500 billion by 2030. Hotels have been quicker to respond: pet-friendly resorts, restaurants, cafés, and even co-working spaces are increasingly commonplace. Aviation is catching up.

Bangkok-based Divya Dugar is a pet parent who has spent years travelling with her three dogs across India by rail and road. She chronicled these experiences in her book *Chaos in a Coupe*. Four years ago, she flew them from Delhi to Paris; and then recently, she travelled with them from Paris to Bangkok.

Her first rule is to begin with the country, not the airline. "Each country has different rules of importing and exporting a dog," she says. Rabies requirements, booster vaccinations, and other documentation can take considerable time. Only once those are in place should travellers begin deciding which airline and route to use.

Dugar recommends using a pet-relocation agency such as PetFly selectively. "Outsource the complicated documentation and airport handling, but not necessarily the entire move." Such agencies can also accompany an animal through parts of the airport inaccessible to its owner and remain with it until it is handed over for the flight.

She favours direct flights whenever possible, choosing Air France for Delhi-Paris for precisely that reason. For an India to the US journey, she recommends Lufthansa via Munich because of the pet-care facilities available during the connection.

Meanwhile, at the luxury end, a new class of pet-first aviation has emerged overseas. Most are public or private charter operators rather than conventional scheduled airlines.

BARK Air was created around the idea of offering dog-first charter flights. It sells a dog-and-human ticket on routes such as New York-San Francisco for around $7,450 and New York-London for roughly $9,900 on selected 2026 flights. K9 Jets, similarly, operates shared private-jet flights for people travelling with animals, including long-haul international sectors. Other operators, including RetrievAir in the US and SingaPaw Air in Asia, have entered the same niche market.

Looks like the 'paw'fect vacation is one where your pooch accompanies you, and airlines are finally coming to your rescue. BT